

Serious Game Project: MVP Design Document

You've identified your topic, tested three different game perspectives, and playtested with real players. Now you're going to document your game in detail before you build it digitally. This design document is your blueprint. It shows what your game looks like, how it works, and why each part matters.

Your design document should have:

- A clear description of your chosen paper prototype
 - Sketches and descriptions of your game screens and mechanics
 - Justification for why this design serves your learning goal
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Part 1 - Your Game at a Glance

Sentence 1: We are making a game about [topic] for [audience], because they are the people who most need to understand it.

The moment you realize that you are alone, you see everyone around you loud and jolly, but none of your friends have spoken to you.(Game is for teenagers)

Sentence 2 - Learning Goal: We want a player to walk away understanding [one specific thing].

The difficulties of teenage social life and how loneliness isn't seen on the surface but is always present, unseen. On top of buildings not being used.

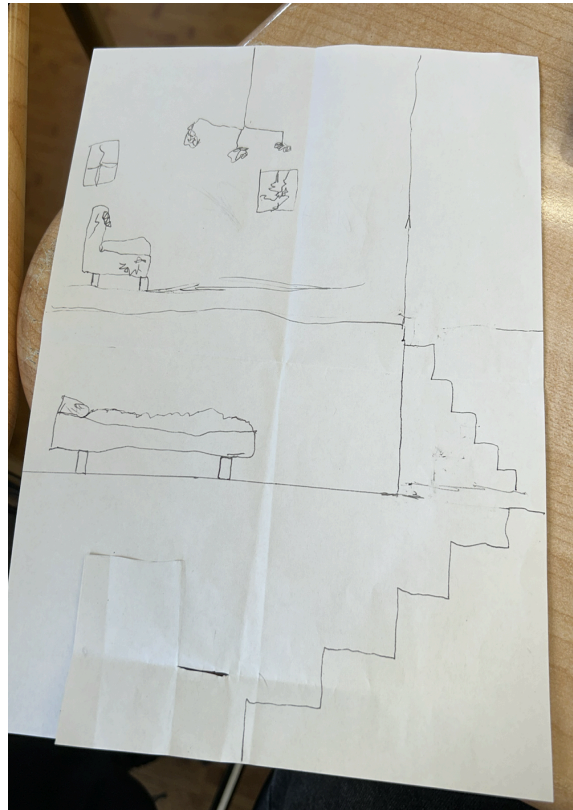
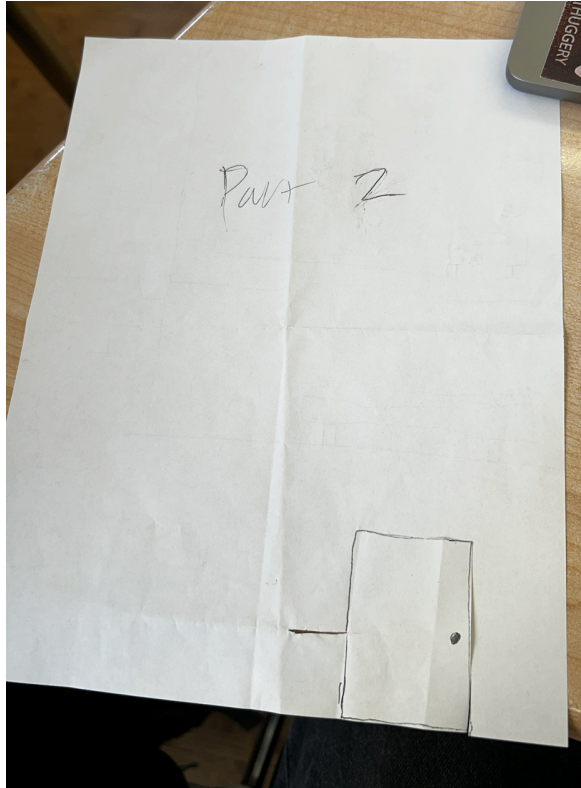
Link to your **Serious Game Project: Brainstorm** and **Serious Game Project: Paper Prototyping** docs here:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1BQYwR_YwHlKmzV06Dr1HPRkO3UQp8vddVzSYf2qeF-Y/edit?usp=sharing

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1kGJygs5yw3os6k1FafmPRAHmVHcdi4TA_ydDvhezW6Y/edit?tab=t.0

Part 2 - Choose Your Paper Prototype

Choose (and refine) your best paper prototype. Add pictures of it here:



Describe how to play your paper prototype.

Clean up trash quests with in-game friends under a time constraint to build bonds and earn money to buy upgrades for the house.

What made this prototype work? Describe one moment from playtesting that showed you this was the right direction. What did a playtester do or say?

The clear goal of picking up trash and the ability to easily see their progress helped players stay motivated and understand exactly how their actions improved the game environment.

Part 3 - Mechanics, Dynamics, Aesthetics

These three things work together to create your game experience.

What is your most important mechanic? The rule or action. (Example: "The player chooses which person to help with limited time per turn.")

The most important mechanic is the quest mechanic. The quest system, where you complete a quest within a certain time limit, further your progress in the game. For example, you have to clean up the inside of an abandoned building, so you have to click on all the pieces of trash to pick them up and throw them away in under ~10 seconds.

What dynamic should this elicit? What happens as a result? What tension or situation does the mechanic create? (Example: "The player faces real tension because they can't help everyone.")

The time-limited quest mechanic creates a sense of urgency, as players must rush to clean up trash before the timer runs out. As a result, it attracts more people and draws attention to the problem. This chain reaction also gives the lonely teen opportunities to make new friends and brings life back to abandoned buildings. Tension is created if the player doesn't finish the mini-game to fix up the building in time, because they will feel alone, as the building is in disarray and not attracting people to live there.

What aesthetic should players feel? What do you want it to feel like to play? (Example: "Stress. Moral weight. The feeling of helplessness in the face of competing needs.")

The players should feel a combination of stress and a sense of completion due to the time limit; it should not be overly relaxed, but they should feel joy upon completing the tasks.

How do these three work together to serve your learning goal?

These three work together because

Part 4 - Mechanics and Story Alignment

Now let's flesh out your paper prototype into a game idea! In a serious game, your mechanics should embody your message, not just decorate it.

What story are you telling? Briefly describe the scenario, the world, or the situation the player enters.

We are trying to tell the story of someone who is building a community by fixing up a property and having people help them along the way.

How do your mechanics embody this story? Don't explain it through dialogue or cutscenes. Explain it through what the player actually does. Why does that specific action matter thematically?

They embody because you are fixing up the building that people will want to stay in and create a community in.

Part 5 - Goals, Subgoals, and Pacing

Overall goal: What is the player trying to accomplish? This should connect to your learning goal.

The overall goal is to clean up buildings while earning enough to buy your own home and make true friends at a time when that's hard.

Subgoals: What are 2-4 smaller objectives the player works toward on the way to the overall goal? (List them in order.)

1. Clean up the abandoned buildings so that they become welcoming and usable space
2. Attract and befriend a small group of neighbors/teens who will help complete quests
3. Upgrade and decorate shared spaces to further grow the community
4. Earn enough money and trust to secure your own home within the community

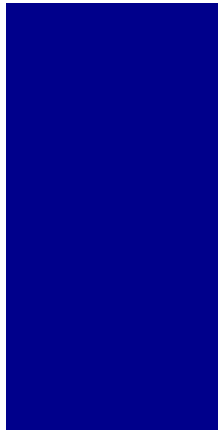
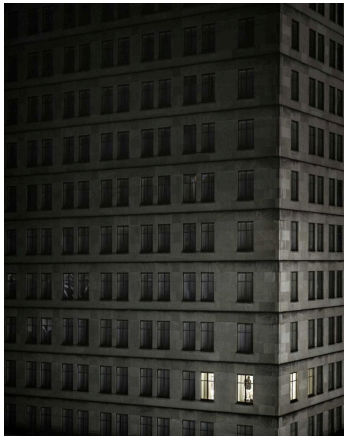
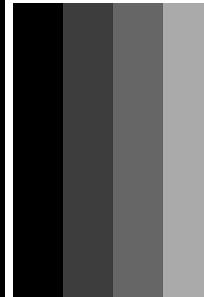
Pacing: How does the game get harder or more complex? When does the player feel successful? When do they feel challenged? You can sketch a quick graph, describe it, or both.

The time limit that was put in place will decrease i

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Part 6 - Your Mood Board

Link or screenshot your mood board from the Brainstorm sheet:



Part 7 - Sketch Your MVG

Sketch out everything that will be needed for your “Minimum Viable Game.” Rough sketches are better than no sketches. These don’t need to be pretty.

What does the player see on screen? Sketch the minimum different views for your game to work.

The player sees a 2D view of a small neighborhood, focusing on one abandoned building at a time, showing the building, the surrounding street, and the general environment where the cleaning and community building can happen.

What are the UI elements? (Player character, enemies, items, obstacles, buttons, counters, timers, text, icons, etc. What’s the minimum that the player would need to see and interact with?)

The UI elements include a visible player character and a few teen NPC friends, clickable trash items and broken objects around the building, a quest box that explains the current goal, a countdown timer that shows how much time is left, a progress bar or counter that tracks how many items have been cleaned, a money or points counter that displays the player’s earnings, a simple friendship meter that shows how many friends the player has made, and basic buttons such as “Start Quest,” “Upgrade,” and “Next Building” so the player can easily interact with the game.

How does the game communicate? How does the player know what happened? (Visual feedback, sounds, text, numbers, images?)

The game communicates through visual changes, sounds, and short text so the player knows what happened: trash disappears and the progress bar fills up when items are cleaned, buildings visually change from dirty and empty to clean and welcoming when a quest is

completed, the timer and screen edges give a warning when time is almost out, simple sound effects and chimes play for actions and successes, and short text messages like “Quest Complete,” “Quest Failed,” and “New Friend Joined” appear on screen to explain the results of the player’s actions.